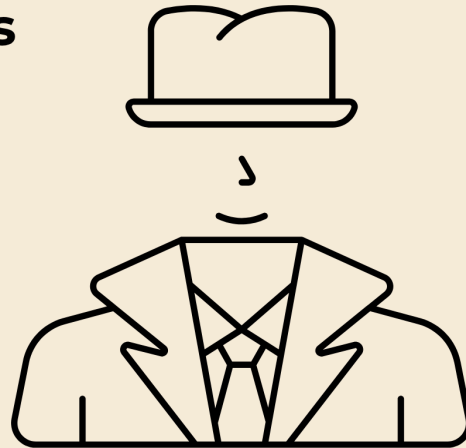




The 'Invisible Resume': What the Internet Says About You

Have you ever tried to Google yourself? You might be amazed or not!



The 'Invisible Resume': What the Internet Says About You

Have you ever tried to Google yourself? What popped up?

If you've never tried, do it and hope that you won't be surprised.

In a world where Google is often the first HR manager, that search result is more powerful than you think. It is what a prospective employer or client would see if they decided to get to know you better, over and above your CV or portfolio.

That's what we call an Invisible Resume. The story everyone online is already reading about you. And honestly, most people don't bother polishing it.

Technology didn't just change how we work; it changed how we're seen. Visibility is the new credibility. Gone are the days when only your paper CV could fight and win your battles in your absence. Now you need to complement your CV with a strong Invisible Resume.

It speaks for you:

- Before an interview.
- Before a client meeting.
- Before someone decides whether to trust you or not.

The First Glimpse Matters

What did you think after hitting the search button? If you haven't, here is what often shows up when someone Googles your name:

1. An array of photos - Yours, and maybe of other people who share the same name.
2. Your LinkedIn profile (*if you have one*).
3. Videos of you from your active social platforms - *even posts from your vacation in Diani*

4. An article or blog you published sometime back, or the one you actively write.

That first page of Google is now your first impression, and you don't get to explain it. For some, this might be a nightmare, but when played right, this is an opportunity to make sure that what is visible helps more than it hurts.

But Google is just the first stop shop.

Why does this matter?

Here are a few things happening in Kenya that make this super important:

1. **Everyone is online**, and more young people are freelancing digitally, not just in Kenya but across the globe.
2. **Recruitment has also changed** - A lot of job advertising, recruiting and connections now happen online through LinkedIn, WhatsApp, and even Facebook. For many Kenyans, completing your profile means more attention.

So, this is not just about global opportunities; even locally - in Nairobi, Kisumu, Mombasa - who you are online is becoming the first way people judge you.



What Can Go Wrong When You Ignore Your Invisible Resume

Think of your **Invisible Resume like footsteps**. People hear them before you walk into the room. If you ignore those footsteps, a few things can happen before you even say hello.

- Old or awkward posts from years ago can paint the wrong picture of who you are today
- An Experience section on LinkedIn that doesn't match your CV can make you look careless, ignorant or inconsistent
- Typos, half-filled profiles, missing photos or generic headshots give an impression of low effort.

- **And the quietest danger is invisibility itself.** If you don't show up in searches or in your professional networks, opportunities will simply pass you by.

Now that it matters: Let's Make Your Invisible Resume Visible

First, you don't need to overthink this and delete all your TikTok videos. First, understand that not all social media channels are listed on search engines.

So instead of doing an overhaul on your whole online life, just start with one or two of these, and build from there.

1. Google yourself and see what others see

- Search your name now. What shows up on page one? Note the first 5 results. Which are good? Which are not so good? Decide what to fix or remove.

2. Polish your LinkedIn.

- It is usually the first thing that pops up, so make it count. Most recruiters will also post jobs there or headhunt candidates. Use a clean, friendly photo.
- Make your headline count (include what you do + what you aim to do + whom you serve/work for).
- Fill the About section with your journey, your skills, what you care about and the impact you have created so far.
- Add skills, courses, examples of work, and even volunteer work. The smallest things count.

3. Clean up the other social media channels (*recently, Instagram started ranking on Google*)

- If you want to keep that part of your life private, consider changing your privacy settings.
- Archive old posts you're not proud of or delete them.
- Review tags. Sometimes other people tag you in stuff you don't want to show. Untag or request removal.
- If you are in the creative space, optimize this to work harder for you by putting out content that your prospective employers or event clients would be interested in.

4. Be consistent and be active

- Post or share something small every few weeks (a project you completed, an insight, something you're learning).
- Engage with your network: comment, share, congratulate others.
- That visibility builds trust and also keeps your digital footprint updated. More relevant work or information will be updated and appear top.



Remember: Small, visible wins matter more than dramatic clean-ups. Do one thing now and follow up later.

Finally, Let the Invisible Resume Work for You. It already exists, so let it begin helping you and tell a story you are proud of.

What's one thing that you will implement today? Share your **Invisible Resume** wins with us at #Careercafeke - we'd love to see how you're showing up online.